

work is valued by those who control the purse strings. You also need to be sure your work is recognized by those people.

The first step to managing your boss is to be sure you understand what is expected of you. As you get clarity, make a list of the items that are most important in ways that are specific and quantifiable. This will eliminate any gray area and establish clear goals for you to work toward that will benefit your employer. Staying with our theme, you are clarifying how you will add value to your company.

Once you understand the expectations, you can exceed those expectations. Focus on over-delivering in the areas your employer most values. If the goal is to grow sales 3 percent, look for ways to grow them by 5 percent. If your goal is to reduce spending by 10 percent, find ways to reduce spending by 20 percent. If the goal is to hit a benchmark in six months, find a way to get there in five months. If you can do this, you will demonstrate value and the reasons you deserve to be paid more.

Doing better work is not enough to guarantee you'll be rewarded. As you hit and exceed these specific and quantifiable goals, keep your boss in the know. This can feel like bragging or taking too much credit, but remember, each time you do, it is an advertisement for